

Library of Congress to Expand Use of LC Genre/Form Terms (LCGFT) and Implement Subject Heading (LCSH and CYAC—Children & Young Adult) Cataloging Simplification

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Effective **February 2, 2026**, the Library of Congress will cease adding form subdivisions (\$v) to the end of LC subject heading strings and expand its use of LCGFT headings. This change in practice ultimately stems from a 2007 study about ways to simplify LCSH cataloging. The Library's development of LCGFT (began in 2007, as a result of the study that year) as auxiliary vocabulary to LCSH was to provide a faceted option for LCSH precoordinated strings, since precoordinated strings combine multiple concepts in one string.

The Library's move to BIBFRAME has been a catalyst for this change. The growth and development of LCGFT over eighteen years and the expansion of the use of URIs, not only in MARC data but also in linked data, mean this change in practice will greatly facilitate the use of URIs in LC data.

This change will be limited to descriptions created in the LC Marva BIBFRAME editor and will appear in modern MARC records. Bibliographic records distributed by the Library will contain a mix of this new practice.

The shorter subject headings may also match existing LCSH/CYAC authority records and their URIs, which is beneficial in a linked data environment. An example of this change follows:

Current MARC record:

650 0 \$a Women human rights workers **\$v** Diaries.

650 0 \$a Human rights workers **\$v** Diaries.

650 0 \$a Young women **\$z** United States **\$v** Diaries.

650 0 \$a Teenage girls **\$z** United States **\$v** Diaries.

Revised MARC record:

650 0 \$a Women human rights workers. **\$0** <http://id.loc.gov/authorities/subjects/sh91006313>

650 0 \$a Human rights workers. **\$0** <http://id.loc.gov/authorities/subjects/sh87003462>

650 0 \$a Young women **\$z** United States. **\$0** <http://id.loc.gov/authorities/subjects/sh2007007836>

650 0 \$a Teenage girls **\$z** United States. **\$0** <http://id.loc.gov/authorities/subjects/sh87007853>

655 7 \$a Diaries. **\$2** lcgft **\$0** <http://id.loc.gov/authorities/genreForms/gf2014026085>

The Policy, Training & Cooperative Programs Division (PTCP) will update the LCGFT Manual, the Subject Headings Manual (SHM), and other documentation to reflect these changes, while filling in any gaps in the LCGFT vocabulary. The CYAC Program will work on the relevant documentation changes as well. LC has no plan to retroactively convert records.

There is no requirement for any institution to follow the Library's practice of not using \$v.

Please check [FAQ](#) for more info.